The present perfect and the past simple: side by side

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red: Unit 17 (page 45): **17.3** and Unit 19 (page 49): **19.4** in class; Additional exercises **19, 20** (page 261). At home: **17.4** (page 45) and **18.4** (page 47).
This week there is no new grammar. This file puts the two tenses side by side.

1 · One question, two tenses

Experience (any time before now): *Have you ever been to an island? → Yes, I have.*
Details (a finished time): *When did you go? — Last summer. What did you see?*

Ask with have, tell with did.

2 · How long vs when

*How long **have** you **lived** here? — For ten years. / Since 2015.* (still true)
*When **did** you **move** here? — Ten years ago. / In 2015.* (finished)

3 · just / already / yet / ever / never

*I've **just** arrived. She has **already** left. He hasn't called **yet**. Have you **ever**...? I've **never**...* → always present perfect, never with a finished time.

4 · Which time word?

present perfect: ever · never · just · already · yet · so far · for · since · today · this week
past simple: yesterday · last week · ago · in 2019 · when I was ten · on Monday

5 · The Russian trap

✗ I ~~have seen~~ him yesterday → I **saw** him yesterday. ✗ I ~~live~~ here since 2015 → I **have lived** here since 2015. ✗ ~~Did~~ you ~~ever~~ be to...? → **Have** you ever been to...? ✗ When ~~have~~ you ~~been~~? → When **did** you go?

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 Choose the correct form

1. I (have lost / lost) my keys yesterday.
2. (Have you ever been / Did you ever be) to an island?
3. She (has lived / lived) in Tashkent since 2015.
4. We (have visited / visited) Samarkand in 2019.
5. He (has just left / just left yesterday).
6. When (have you been / did you go) to the beach?
7. I (haven't seen / didn't see) him this week.
8. How long (have you known / did you know) Ali?

2 Put the verb in the correct form

1. I ____ (never / see) the ocean.
2. We ____ (arrive) at the island yesterday.
3. She ____ (live) here for ten years.
4. They ____ (not / finish) the project yet.
5. He ____ (win) a prize in 2020.
6. ____ you ____ (ever / meet) a famous person?

3 Translate into English

1. Ты когда-нибудь был на острове?

2. Мы были там в прошлом году.

3. Он живёт здесь с 2015 года.

4. Я уже поел.

5. Когда ты вернулся?

6. Они ещё не приехали.

7. Я никогда не видел океан.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 Interview a partner: Have you ever...? When did you...?

Ask 6 pairs of questions: *Have you ever been to the sea? When did you go? Have you ever won a prize? What was it?* Write the answers in full sentences.

5 Complete the story: present perfect or past simple

My uncle (1 be) _____ a sailor for thirty years. He (2 visit) _____ more than twenty countries, but he (3 never / lose) _____ his love for the sea. In 2005 he (4 find) _____ a small island that nobody (5 know) _____ before. He (6 stay) _____ there for a week. "(7 you / ever / feel) _____ real peace?" he asks me. I (8 never / feel) _____ it like that. Last summer he (9 take) _____ me to the sea, and I (10 understand) _____ him.

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 lost · Have you ever been · has lived · visited · has just left · did you go · haven’t seen · have you known

2 have never seen · arrived · has lived · haven’t finished · won · Have you ever met

3 Have you ever been to an island? · We were there last year. · He has lived here since 2015. · I have already eaten. · When did you come back? · They haven’t arrived yet. · I have never seen the ocean.

4 Own answers.

5 has been · has visited · has never lost · found · knew (had known) · stayed · Have you ever felt · have never felt · took · understood